HHH-S-620e
August 18, 1966

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. HHH-S-00620d (AGR-C&MS)
May 27, 1965 and
Fed. Spec. HHH-S-620c
September 13, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SPINACH, FROZEN

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for frozen spinach for use by all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Styles.* Frozen spinach shall be of the following styles in accordance with the current U. S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Spinach, as specified (see 6.1):

(a) Whole leaf.
(b) Cut leaf (or sliced).
(c) Chopped.

1.2.2 *Grades.* Frozen spinach shall be of the following grades in accordance with the current U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Spinach, as specified (see 6.1):

Fancy (grade A).
Extra standard (grade B).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-F-690—Frozen Fruits and Vegetables; Packaging, Packing, Labeling, and Marking of.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-668—Sanitary Standards for Food Plants.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Copies may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

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United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Spinach.
United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.
Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products.

(Copies may be obtained, without charge, from the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Consumer and Marketing Service, Washington, D.C., 20250.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D.C., 20044.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Frozen spinach shall be prepared from the clean, sound, succulent leaves and stems of fresh spinach. Unless otherwise specified, the frozen product shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.3 Description of grades. Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms) contained in 1.2.1 and 1.2.2 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Spinach, (and lot compliance applicable thereto as set forth in the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products), in effect on the date of invitation for bids.

3.4 Sanitation and workmanship. Frozen spinach shall be processed under sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be frozen and maintained at temperatures necessary for the preservation of the product. Containers shall be clean and well-sealed, and shall otherwise conform to the applicable provisions of the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

3.5 Condition at time of delivery. Frozen spinach shall be in a frozen state with an internal temperature of 0°F. or less; shall show no evidence of refreezing; and otherwise shall be in good condition at time of delivery.

3.6 Military agencies. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.* Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 *Factory inspection.* The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 *Final inspection.* Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.4 and 6.5).

4.2.4 *Inspection of containers.* When inspection of the product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards

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for Condition of Food Containers pertaining to processed fruits and vegetables shall apply.

4.2.5 *Responsibility for inspection.* The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Agriculture certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required by the contract or order.

4.2.5.1 Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.6 *Inspection of packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.* Inspection shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of PPP-F-690.

4.2.7 *Preacceptance (plant sanitation) inspection—military agencies.* Award of contracts shall be limited to plants which have received prior sanitary approval by the Military Veterinary Service in accordance with MIL-STD-668 or to plants operating under the continuous inspection service of the Processed Products Standardization and Inspection Branch, Consumer and Marketing Service, United States Department of Agriculture, as officially listed by that agency.

4.3 **Tests.** Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the contractor if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government inspection activity determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the contractor will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-F-690, as specified for the applicable levels (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Style and grade of product required (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).
(*c*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).

6.2 This specification does not include all grades of frozen spinach that are commercially available, but is intended to cover the grades that are normally suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 If samples with bids are necessary they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.4 **Contractor's inspection.** The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification

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prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.5 **Destination inspection.** When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—67

Review activities:

Army—GL, MD
Navy—SA, MC
Air Force—67

Review/user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing of DOD Standardization Documents.

CIVIL AGENCY INTEREST:

Preparing activity:

Agr—C&MS

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